

CANDY DIALOGUE CREATOR

Instructions

1.0.0

Thank you for downloading Candy Dialogue Creator, a project by Candy Arts!

Candy DC & Candy DE

Candy Dialogue Creator (Candy DC) is a standalone GUI for creating and editing dialogues in the Candy Dialogue Engine format.

You're probably used to dialogue systems where the dialogue editing UI is integrated, so let us explain:

Candy Dialogue Engine (Candy DE) is a very extensive and powerful dialogue system, also made by Candy Arts. It's offered separately from Candy DC as an asset to be integrated into any of your Godot projects.

In summary: Candy DE runs dialogues in your game, while Candy DC is an external tool you can use to write dialogues.

Features

Candy DC can do the following:

- Access your project files to read and display resources and variables.
- Select project data from drop-down lists to reduce typing.
- Preview project media files, such as portraits, voice files, etc. with mouse hover
- Write advanced dialogues without special syntax: insert dialogue lines in one click, then fill-in data (with helpful labels and tooltips).
- Create and insert custom dialogue line templates with pre-filled data.
- Tools for easy writing: one-click BBCode insert, custom string inserts, on-screen preview, etc.
- Translation UI features that make translating faster and provide context.
- Export dialogues as .txt files to your project folder, to be loaded and run by Candy DE.
- One-click 'test' export to your project folder.

Usage

Candy DC can be used in three different ways:

- Compiled** → Run the compiled version for your operating system, for best performance.
- Raw** → Open the raw project files in Godot, modify them, and compile them or run them directly from the Godot editor.
- Integrated** → Add the scripts, scenes and resources to your Godot project, so as to integrate Candy DC in your game. This can allow you or your players to create and edit dialogues from inside the game at runtime, for instant testing or for modding. Note that this requires at least intermediate-level skills in Godot to setup.

Note that the 'Integrated' method has various benefits but is not required for testing or modding: Candy DC provides a feature to export dialogues to your game project (or installation folder) in one click for testing, and you can setup your game to read and load dialogue files, created externally by players, at runtime.

The Integrated method will require some modification of the code to work properly in compiled projects. A ready-made 'Integrated' edition of Candy DC is in the works and will be released very soon.

Getting Started

Executable (Compiled):

1. Download the executable for your operating system from Github (<https://github.com/Candy-Arts/Candy-Dialogue-Creator/releases>).
 2. Unpack the downloaded compressed file to any location you want on your computer.
 3. Read the Instructions.pdf file inside the folder.
 4. Launch the executable.
 5. It takes several seconds to load. You'll land on the profile menu. Create a new profile (give it a name that references the project it's for).
 6. Click the profile in the list, then click the 'Select' button.
 7. You'll arrive at the Main UI screen, where you can start adding lines to create a dialogue. But first, read the 'Quick Setup' guide in the Documentation folder to learn how to configure your profile.
- Read the 'Example Dialogue' guide in the Documentation folder to learn how to create a basic dialogue.
 - The rest of the documentation will explain the remaining features.
 - Don't forget to download [Candy Dialogue Engine](#) and integrate it to your project, otherwise dialogues won't work.

Raw Project:

- Download the source code for the latest release from Github (<https://github.com/Candy-Arts/Candy-Dialogue-Creator/releases>).
- Unpack the downloaded compressed file to any location you want on your computer.
- Open Godot and import the Candy_Dialogue_Creator folder as a project.
- Open it, edit it as you want, run it from the Godot editor, or compile it.

Once you're ready to use Candy DC, you should read the guide titled "Setup": it provides instructions on how to configure Candy DC upon your first use.

Godot Compatibility

The compiled version of Candy DC has no Godot compatibility requirements: it's compiled and just runs.

The raw project and the integrated versions are compatible with Godot 4.5 and 4.6. Earlier versions are not compatible, mainly due to the lack of the OptionButton class.

Bug Reports

Bugs can be reported on github:

<https://github.com/Candy-Arts/Candy-Dialogue-Creator/issues>

Licensing

Candy Dialogue Creator is published under the MIT License, and is free to download and use.

Candy Dialogue Engine

Candy DE can be downloaded from github:

<https://github.com/Candy-Arts/Candy-Dialogue-Engine>

For an overview of its features, see the Candy Arts website:

<https://candy-arts.com/index.php/candy-dialogue-engine/>